

c. 1937

The following is a faithful transcription of a carbon copy of a typed letter by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey O.F.M.Cap.

Rev. Edward F. Casey  
Batangas Batangas  
Philippine Islands

My Dear Brother Edward:-

God bless you . I hope you are well - you and yours. Though it is just striking 11 p.m. I want to at least start you a few words before retiring after this busy day, and in a way even for me eventful day. For yourself of course, and for every one whose privilege it has been to be in immediate touch with the Eucharistic Congress out there in the Philippines it has been no doubt more than eventful. However, we here get the announcements over the radio about 8 a.m. in Detroit and heard the Holy Father's own voice and benediction. His conclusion with benediction seemed to be really: ".in Nomine Patris et Filii et Spiritus Sancti". I hope you may send us details worth while. The press here - even the Catholic part of it has been very tame so far about this great event. I hope to learn that it surpassed in solemnity and impressiveness even the grandeur, etc, of the Congress in Ireland, of which Cardinal Hayes is said to have remarked: "It surpassed the insurpassible".

Having barely missed going to that great event I almost dreamed of my going this one in '37. Had it been closer to the time of your jubilee I would possibly have been sent. I have not been anxious, however, to undertake such an expensive and extraordinary trip, - unless of course some additional duty should waft me thither. That I was sent to help Father Maurice to celebrate, seemed quite appropriate at the time. Now it seems to have been fortunate. In fact I believe quite a few blessings came as a consequence to myself & more. I have a letter from a certain ascetic invalid, Mary Kerrman of St. Elizabeth Hospital, Elizabeth New Jersey, I want to inclose... well, just as a sample.

Asking for details about the great Congress, I hope you may not think of taking as a criterion the example of the present writer. I am sure you expected some report about our visit in New York last June. As a matter of fact I started more than once to give you a short summary of my ten-day diversion, on that occasion. Hoping that it may not be without interest, I'll try just briefly to give you an idea about the whole affair even though belated.

Father M. Joachim seems to have spoken to Rev. Father Provincial about it some months before, and the latter told me it would be alright..... I started off Wednesday evening June 3rd. The evening and night were ideal in sun-set and moon-light, we crossed the Niagara about 13 miles above the Falls but even at that the waters seemed to be swirling on to as if rushing to a tragedy. Though I slept very little I was not tired when the dawn revealed we were descending the Mohawk Valley stopping only once or twice